

INFORMATION SYSTEM ANALYSIS AND DESIGN REPORT OF BRAC

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Contents

1	Introduction and Company Overview	3
1.1	Introduction	3
1.2	BRAC's History	4
1.3	Vision	4
1.4	Mission	4
1.5	Company Organization	5
1.6	Activities Performed by BRAC	6
1.7	BRAC's Multifaceted Approach to Social Development	7
1.8	Ongoing Programs	8
1.9	Conclusion	9
2	System Development Life Cycle of BRAC	11
2.1	Introduction	11
2.2	Recognition of Need	11
2.3	Feasibility Study	11
2.4	Analysis	12
2.5	Design	12
2.6	Implementation	13
2.7	Post-Implementation and Maintenance	13
2.8	Conclusion	14
3	Role of a System Analyst	15
3.1	Introduction	15
3.2	Profile of Interviewee	15
3.3	Project team structure	16
3.3.1	Description of Roles	16
3.4	Key Responsibilities & Activities	17
3.4.1	Requirement Gathering and Analysis:	18
3.4.2	Process Modeling and Workflow Design:	18
3.4.3	System Design and Implementation:	18
3.4.4	Data Management and Analysis:	18
3.4.5	Training and Support:	19
3.5	Skills & Qualifications	19
3.5.1	Interpersonal Skills:	19
3.5.2	Technical Proficiency:	20

3.5.3	Analytical Skills:	20
3.6	Challenges & Opportunities	20
3.6.1	Data Management Issues:	20
3.6.2	Technological Challenges:	20
3.6.3	Communication Barriers:	21
3.6.4	Opportunities:	21
3.7	Conclusion	22
4	Systems Planning and the Initial Investigation	23
4.1	Introduction	23
4.2	Initial Investigation	23
4.2.1	Needs Assessment	23
4.2.2	Community Mobilization	24
4.2.3	Stakeholder Engagement	24
4.2.4	Pilot Projects	24
4.2.5	Policy Advocacy	24
4.2.6	Research and Data Collection	24
4.3	Resource Allocation	24
4.3.1	Community-Centered Approach	24
4.3.2	Collaborative Partnerships	25
4.3.3	Integrated Services	25
4.3.4	Sustainability and Scalability	25
4.4	Prototyping	26
4.4.1	Pilot Projects	26
4.4.2	Innovative Interventions	26
4.4.3	Urban Innovation Challenge	26
4.4.4	Customization and Flexibility	26
4.5	Conclusion	26
5	Analyzing BRAC's Policies, Objectives, Goals, Structure, System, Leadership, History, and an Interview	27
5.1	Introduction	27
5.2	Methodology	27
5.3	Results	27
5.3.1	BRAC's Policies	27
5.3.2	BRAC's Objectives	28
5.3.3	BRAC's Goals	28
5.3.4	Organizational Structure	28
5.3.5	Type of System	28
5.3.6	Leadership and Key Personnel	28
5.4	Data Flow Diagram of BRAC	29
5.5	Interview with Talha Tasnim	30
5.6	Conclusion	32

Chapter 1

Introduction and Company Overview

This chapter provides a foundational introduction to the system analysis report, offering insights into the operations of BRAC, a leading NGO based in Bangladesh. It underscores the critical importance of system analysis in optimizing computer-based systems within organizational frameworks. By delving into BRAC's illustrious history, it highlights the organization's vision, mission, company profile, and both ongoing and completed projects. BRAC remains steadfast in its dedication to eradicating poverty and promoting social justice, empowering communities across the globe. Subsequent chapters will delve into a comprehensive examination of BRAC's systems, proposing actionable strategies to enhance their effectiveness and efficiency.

1.1 Introduction

In the modern era, organizations heavily rely on computer systems to streamline operations, enhance efficiency, and foster innovation. However, as these systems grow in complexity, ensuring their seamless functionality becomes increasingly vital. This is where system analysis plays a pivotal role. By scrutinizing the interplay of various components within these systems, organizations can identify areas for improvement and optimization. System analysis serves as a cornerstone for companies, enabling them to maintain a competitive edge and adapt to evolving technological landscapes.

In this report, we embark on a comprehensive examination of the systems employed by BRAC, a global leader in the field of development. From education to healthcare, microfinance to social development, BRAC's multifaceted initiatives necessitate robust and efficient systems to support their endeavors. By exploring the intricacies of BRAC's systems, we aim to uncover opportunities for enhancement and propose strategies to further amplify the organization's impact. Through this analysis, we endeavor to contribute to BRAC's ongoing mission of empowering individuals and communities worldwide.

1.2 BRAC's History

BRAC, originally known as the Bangladesh Rehabilitation Assistance Committee, later renamed the Bangladesh Rural Advancement Committee, and subsequently rebranded as Building Resources Across Communities, has a rich and storied history dating back to its inception in 1972. Founded by the visionary Sir Fazle Hasan Abed, BRAC emerged in the aftermath of Bangladesh's war of independence, with a primary focus on providing relief and rehabilitation to war refugees.

Over the years, BRAC has evolved into the largest non-governmental development organization globally, with a presence in all 64 districts of Bangladesh and operations spanning across 16 other countries in Asia, Africa, and the Americas. The organization boasts an extensive workforce of over 90,000 individuals, with approximately 70 percent being women, reflecting BRAC's commitment to gender equality and empowerment.

BRAC's mission to alleviate poverty and promote social justice is reflected in its diverse range of initiatives, which encompass education, healthcare, microfinance, agriculture, and social development. Notably, BRAC operates several social enterprises, including a dairy and food project, retail handicraft stores under the brand Aarong, and agricultural ventures, which contribute to the organization's self-sustainability.

Throughout its history, BRAC has demonstrated a steadfast commitment to innovation and effectiveness. In response to pressing societal challenges, BRAC pioneered groundbreaking initiatives such as the Oral Therapy Extension Programme (OTEP) to combat diarrhea, which significantly reduced child mortality rates across Bangladesh. Additionally, BRAC's Rural Development Programme (RDP) has empowered millions of individuals through access to credit and savings facilities, catalyzing economic growth and community development.

As BRAC continues to expand its reach and impact globally, its history serves as a testament to the organization's unwavering dedication to improving the lives of the most marginalized and vulnerable populations worldwide.

1.3 Vision

BRAC envisions a world free from all forms of exploitation and discrimination, where every individual has the opportunity to realize their full potential. In this vision, barriers of gender, socioeconomic status, ethnicity, and other factors are dismantled, creating a society where equality and justice prevail. BRAC's vision encompasses a holistic approach to development, aiming to empower individuals and communities to lead dignified and fulfilling lives. By fostering environments of inclusivity, equity, and opportunity, BRAC seeks to create a world where every person can thrive and contribute meaningfully to their communities and societies.

1.4 Mission

BRAC's mission is to empower people and communities facing poverty, illiteracy, disease, and social injustice. Through our interventions, we strive to catalyze large-scale, positive

transformations by implementing economic and social programs. These initiatives are designed to enable individuals, regardless of gender, to unlock their full potential and lead self-sufficient and fulfilling lives. By addressing systemic inequalities and providing comprehensive support, we work towards creating a more equitable and prosperous society for all.

1.5 Company Organization

BRAC's organizational structure is designed to facilitate effective communication and coordination across different levels of governance and management.

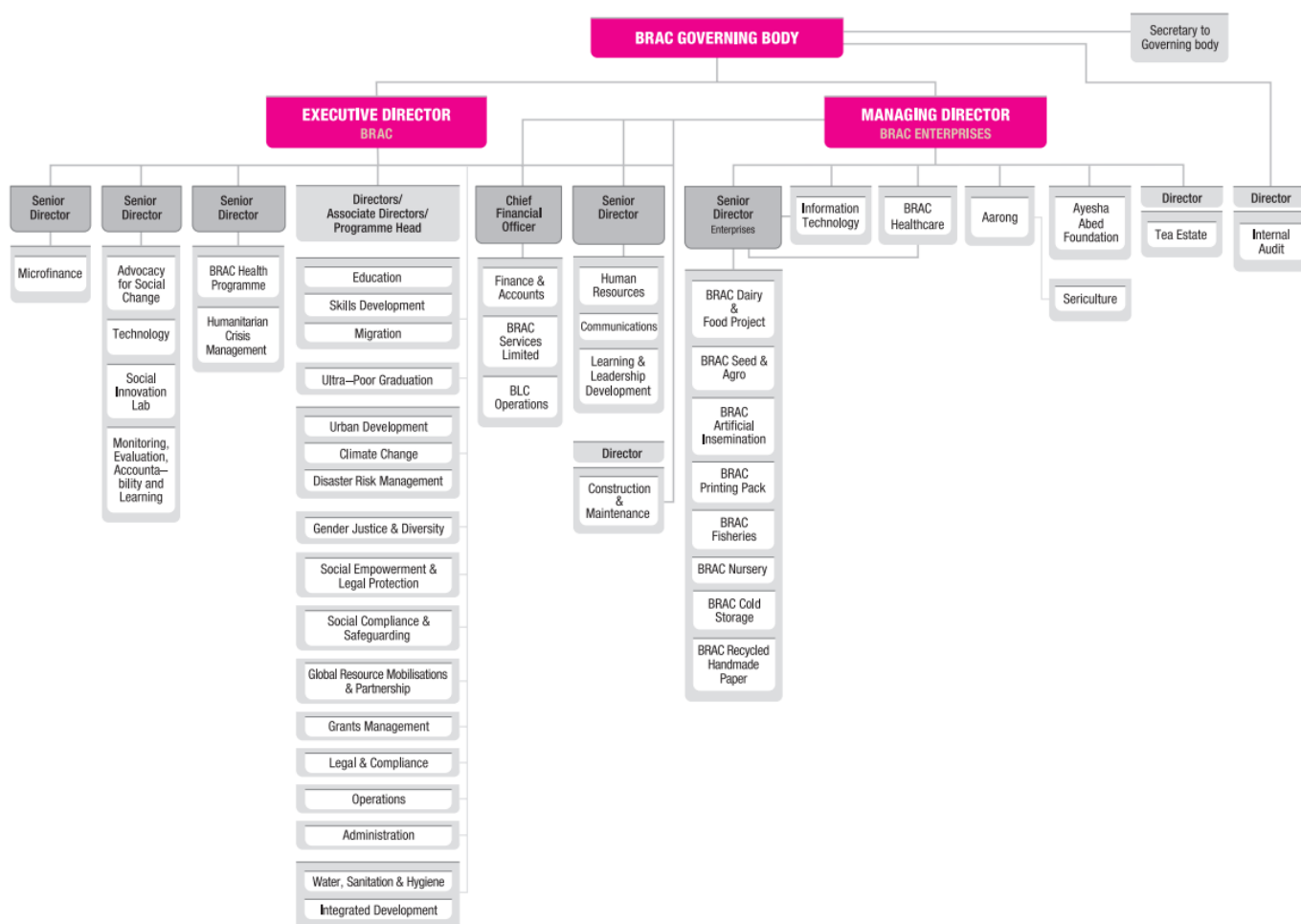


Figure 1.1: Organization of BRAC.

1. **Governing Body:** At the highest level, BRAC is governed by its Board of Directors. Comprising individuals with diverse expertise and backgrounds, the Board provides strategic direction and oversight to the organization.

2. **Executive Director (BRAC) & Managing Director (BRAC Enterprise):** Reporting directly to the Board, the Executive Director oversees BRAC's overall operations, ensuring alignment with organizational goals. Similarly, the Managing Director of BRAC Enterprise is responsible for driving growth and sustainability in BRAC's enterprises.
3. **Senior Director, Associate Director, Chief Financial Officer:** Under the Executive Director and Managing Director, a tier of senior leadership exists, including Senior Directors, Associate Directors, and the Chief Financial Officer. These leaders contribute to strategic planning, decision-making, and resource management.
4. **Heads of Individual Departments:** Departments within BRAC are headed by experienced professionals who oversee day-to-day operations and implement organizational strategies. They facilitate communication between senior management and their teams.

Vertical Communication: The organizational structure fosters vertical communication channels between levels, ensuring a smooth flow of information, directives, and feedback. This enables the alignment of goals and effective decision-making.

This structure supports BRAC's mission and enables the organization to address challenges and drive positive impact effectively.

1.6 Activities Performed by BRAC

1. **Ultra-poor Graduation:** Implementing innovative approaches to lift the ultra-poor out of poverty through a comprehensive and tailored intervention program.
2. **Integrated Development:** Fostering sustainable development by addressing interconnected issues such as poverty, education, healthcare, and livelihoods.
3. **Microfinance:** Providing access to financial services and empowering individuals to start or expand their businesses through microfinance initiatives.
4. **Skills Development:** Equipping individuals with the necessary skills and training to enhance employability and economic opportunities.
5. **Migration:** Supporting migrant workers with pre-departure orientation, skill development, and reintegration programs to ensure safe and dignified migration experiences.
6. **Climate Change:** Implementing initiatives to mitigate the impacts of climate change and promote environmental sustainability.
7. **Disaster Risk Management:** Building resilience and preparedness among communities to mitigate the effects of natural disasters and climate-related hazards.
8. **Gender Justice and Diversity:** Promoting gender equality, diversity, and inclusion through advocacy, awareness-raising, and capacity-building initiatives.

9. **Social Empowerment and Legal Protection:** Providing legal aid, advocacy, and support services to marginalized and vulnerable groups to uphold their rights and access justice.
10. **Strengthening Bangladesh's RMG Sector:** Enhancing the resilience and sustainability of Bangladesh's Ready-Made Garment (RMG) industry through capacity-building, safety, and compliance initiatives.
11. **Health:** Delivering comprehensive healthcare services, including primary healthcare, maternal and child health, and disease prevention and treatment.
12. **Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH):** Improving access to clean water, sanitation facilities, and promoting hygiene practices to enhance public health outcomes.
13. **Urban Development:** Addressing urban challenges and promoting inclusive and sustainable urban development through infrastructure, livelihoods, and social programs.
14. **Education:** Increasing access to quality education, improving learning outcomes, and enhancing educational opportunities for children and adults.
15. **Youth Platform:** Providing platforms and opportunities for youth engagement, empowerment, and leadership development to foster positive social change and innovation.

1.7 BRAC's Multifaceted Approach to Social Development

Under this comprehensive approach, BRAC implements various initiatives aimed at facilitating social transformation and addressing a wide range of challenges. These initiatives include:

1. **Social Development:** BRAC focuses on eight programmatic priorities, including eliminating extreme poverty, expanding financial choices, providing employable skills for decent work, addressing climate change and emergencies, promoting gender equality, ensuring universal healthcare, supporting pro-poor urban development, and investing in the next generation.
2. **Humanitarian Response:** BRAC responds to natural and manmade disasters across the country and provides comprehensive services to Rohingya and host communities in Cox's Bazar.
3. **Social Enterprises:** BRAC develops solutions for social challenges and generates surplus for greater impact through initiatives that engage individuals, micro and small enterprises as suppliers, producers, and consumers.
4. **BRAC University:** BRAC University is committed to creating a functional elite responsive to the needs of the whole society. It provides the tools required in health, education, governance, and business to change systems of inequity that keep people trapped in poverty and discrimination.

5. **Stichting BRAC International:** This non-profit foundation in the Netherlands governs and manages all BRAC entities outside Bangladesh, except for affiliates. The entities are legally registered with relevant authorities in compliance with all applicable legal and regulatory requirements.
6. **Investments:** BRAC engages in socially responsible investments that assist in its mission. Its network of investments helps strive towards the goal of self-sustainability.
7. **Affiliates:**
 1. **BRAC USA:** The North American affiliate of BRAC, BRAC USA provides comprehensive support to BRAC worldwide by raising awareness about its work and mobilizing resources to strengthen programs.
 2. **BRAC UK:** The European affiliate of BRAC, BRAC UK works to raise resources for BRAC programs in Africa and Asia by developing partnerships with local and global organizations, donor agencies, academic and research institutions, and governments.

Under this integrated approach, BRAC aims to create lasting positive change and empower individuals and communities to overcome social, economic, and environmental challenges.

1.8 Ongoing Programs

Under ongoing programs, BRAC is actively engaged in several initiatives aimed at addressing diverse societal challenges and promoting sustainable development. These initiatives include:

1. **Monitoring and Evaluation for Learning and Adaptation (MELA) Initiative:** Established by BIGD, the MELA initiative supports development organizations and donors in finding the right balance of management coordination where learning the roles of M&E are promoted without compromising the accountability requirement for development effectiveness.
2. **Hope – (ASHA):** This bilateral chair application involves Swansea University and two institutes within BRAC University, BIGD, and BRAC IED. It focuses on research on psychological and mental health as an instrument for socio-economic development, with teams working closely in partnership on design and content development for the website.
3. **Women’s Economic Empowerment and Digital Finance (WEE-DiFine):** WEE-DiFine is a research initiative aiming to generate a comprehensive body of evidence around the impact of digital finance on women’s economic empowerment through rigorous research studies across South Asia and Sub-Saharan Africa.
4. **Women’s Economic Empowerment and Digital Connectivity (WEE-Connect):** WEE-Connect addresses the gender gap in digital connectivity in the Global South,

aiming to foster economic empowerment and establish evidence-based strategies through inclusive research and the creation of a scholarly community.

5. **Covid-19 Learning, Evidence and Research Program in Bangladesh (CLEAR):** Led by the Institute of Development Studies (IDS) in collaboration with BIGD, CLEAR aims to support an evidence-informed Covid-19 response and recovery in Bangladesh by delivering policy-relevant research and evidence and supporting increased evidence uptake among policymakers.
6. **Historicizing BRAC:** This project aims to meticulously document BRAC’s approach to development, growth trajectory, and critical inflection points through historical accounts of the organization’s major development programs.
7. **Rapid Research Response to COVID-19 (RRR):** BIGD conducts immediate, rapid research on key areas to analyze the economic impact of COVID-19 in Bangladesh.
8. **Applied Research and Implementation Initiative (DigiDev):** DigiDev, funded by the Wellspring Philanthropic Fund, aims to develop the organizational capacities of BRAC and BRAC International to integrate digital innovations into poverty programs.
9. **Digitizing Implementation Monitoring and Public Procurement Project (DIMAPPP):** DIMAPPP, a government project implemented by BIGD, aims to improve public procurement performance and enhance capacity for implementation and monitoring of public work projects.
10. **Gender and Adolescence: Global Evidence (GAGE):** BIGD is a research partner in GAGE, a program building evidence on good practice initiatives and policies that support adolescents in low- and middle-income countries to reach their full potential.

These ongoing programs reflect BRAC’s commitment to addressing complex societal challenges and advancing sustainable development through evidence-based research and innovative interventions.

1.9 Conclusion

In this chapter, we have provided an overview of BRAC, detailing its vision, mission, company profile, ongoing projects, and organizational structure. BRAC’s vision of creating a world free from exploitation and discrimination, coupled with its mission to empower individuals and communities, reflects its commitment to social development and poverty alleviation.

Through its diverse range of activities, including ultra-poor graduation, integrated development, microfinance, healthcare services, and education, BRAC has made significant strides in addressing key societal challenges and promoting sustainable development. The organization’s robust organizational structure, characterized by hierarchical levels of governance and management, ensures effective communication and coordination, enabling BRAC to achieve its objectives efficiently.

Looking ahead, BRAC remains steadfast in its dedication to creating positive change and fostering inclusive growth. By continuing to innovate, collaborate, and adapt to emerging challenges, BRAC will remain a beacon of hope for millions of individuals worldwide, empowering them to realize their full potential and build brighter futures for themselves and their communities.

Chapter 2

System Development Life Cycle of BRAC

2.1 Introduction

BRAC, a prominent non-governmental development organization, adopts a structured System Development Life Cycle (SDLC) to ensure its programs and systems are effective, efficient, and sustainable. This report details the stages of BRAC's SDLC, emphasizing the recognition of need, feasibility studies, analysis, design, implementation, post-implementation, and maintenance. Additionally, it discusses political considerations, planning and control, and prototyping.

2.2 Recognition of Need

Objective: Identify the problem or opportunity that necessitates the development of a new system or program.

- **Problem Identification:** BRAC identifies critical issues affecting communities through surveys, community meetings, and data analysis. For example, recognizing the need for better maternal healthcare in rural areas.
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Engages with local communities, beneficiaries, staff, and partners to gather insights and confirm the need for intervention.

2.3 Feasibility Study

Objective: Assess the practicality and potential impact of the proposed system or program.

- **Technical Feasibility:** Evaluates whether the necessary technology and expertise are available.
- **Economic Feasibility:** Assesses cost-effectiveness and potential return on investment.

- **Operational Feasibility:** Examines if the organization has the capability to implement and sustain the project.
- **Legal and Environmental Feasibility:** Considers any legal or environmental constraints.

Example: Before launching a new microfinance initiative, BRAC conducts a feasibility study to determine the financial viability and operational capacity needed.

2.4 Analysis

Objective: Detailed examination of the requirements and specifications for the new system or program.

- **Requirement Gathering:** Collects detailed requirements from stakeholders to ensure all needs are addressed.
- **Gap Analysis:** Identifies gaps between current capabilities and desired outcomes.
- **Risk Analysis:** Assesses potential risks and develops mitigation strategies.

Example: For an educational program, BRAC analyzes current literacy rates, existing educational facilities, and community needs to design a comprehensive intervention.

2.5 Design

Objective: Develop a detailed blueprint for the new system or program.

- **Conceptual Design:** High-level design that outlines the overall structure and approach.
- **Detailed Design:** Specifies the technical and functional aspects, including system architecture, user interfaces, and data flow.
- **Prototyping:** Develops prototypes to test concepts, gather user feedback, and make iterative improvements.

Example: In designing a new health information system, BRAC creates prototypes of the user interface and workflow processes to refine the design based on feedback.

2.6 Implementation

Objective: Deploy the system or program and ensure it is operational.

- **Development:** Constructs the system components or program elements as per the design specifications.
- **Integration:** Combines various components and ensures they function together seamlessly.
- **Testing:** Conducts rigorous testing, including user acceptance testing, to ensure the system meets requirements.
- **Training:** Provides comprehensive training for users and administrators.

Example: BRAC rolls out a new agricultural support program, providing tools, training, and resources to farmers, ensuring all elements are in place and functional.

2.7 Post-Implementation and Maintenance

Objective: Monitor the system's performance and make necessary adjustments.

- **Performance Monitoring:** Continuously tracks the system or program to ensure it meets objectives.
- **Feedback Collection:** Regularly gathers feedback from users to identify areas for improvement.
- **Maintenance:** Performs ongoing maintenance, including updates and enhancements.

Example: After implementing a new water sanitation project, BRAC monitors water quality and community usage, making adjustments as needed to improve the system.

Considerations for Candidate Systems: Political Considerations

Objective: Address political and organizational factors that could impact the system's success.

- **Stakeholder Alignment:** Ensures alignment with local and national government policies and priorities.
- **Advocacy and Lobbying:** Engages in advocacy to garner political support and secure necessary approvals.
- **Conflict Management:** Identifies and mitigates potential political conflicts or resistance.

Planning and Control for System Success

Objective: Ensure effective planning and control mechanisms to achieve system success.

- **Project Management:** Utilizes robust project management methodologies to plan, execute, and monitor projects.
- **Resource Allocation:** Ensures adequate resources, including budget, personnel, and technology.
- **Performance Metrics:** Establishes clear metrics to measure success and track progress.

Prototyping

Objective: Develop and test preliminary versions of the system to refine concepts and functionalities.

- **Rapid Prototyping:** Quickly develops prototypes to test ideas and gather early feedback.
- **Iterative Refinement:** Uses feedback from prototypes to make continuous improvements.
- **User Involvement:** Involves users in the prototyping process to ensure the final system meets their needs.

Example: BRAC develops a prototype of a mobile app for financial literacy, testing it with a small group of users and refining it based on their input before full-scale deployment.

2.8 Conclusion

BRAC's System Development Life Cycle is a comprehensive and structured approach that ensures the successful development and implementation of its programs and systems. By meticulously following each stage—from recognizing the need to post-implementation and maintenance—BRAC can effectively address community needs, mitigate risks, and ensure sustainable impact. This structured approach, combined with considerations for political factors and rigorous planning, positions BRAC as a leader in innovative development solutions.

Chapter 3

Role of a System Analyst

3.1 Introduction

In recent years, the field of urban development has witnessed significant transformations driven by technological advancements, evolving socio-economic dynamics, and the increasing need for sustainable solutions. In this context, organizations like BRAC UDP play a pivotal role in addressing the complex challenges faced by urban communities and fostering inclusive development.

The purpose of this chapter is to analyze the roles and responsibilities related to systems analysis and design within BRAC UDP, based on insights gathered from the interviews conducted by our team members. Through these interviews, we aim to gain a deeper understanding of the processes, challenges, and opportunities associated with the analysis and design of systems within the organization.

3.2 Profile of Interviewee

To gain a comprehensive understanding of the roles and responsibilities related to systems analysis and design within BRAC UDP, we conducted interviews with a diverse group of stakeholders involved in various capacities within the organization. Below is a summary of the profiles of the key interviewees:

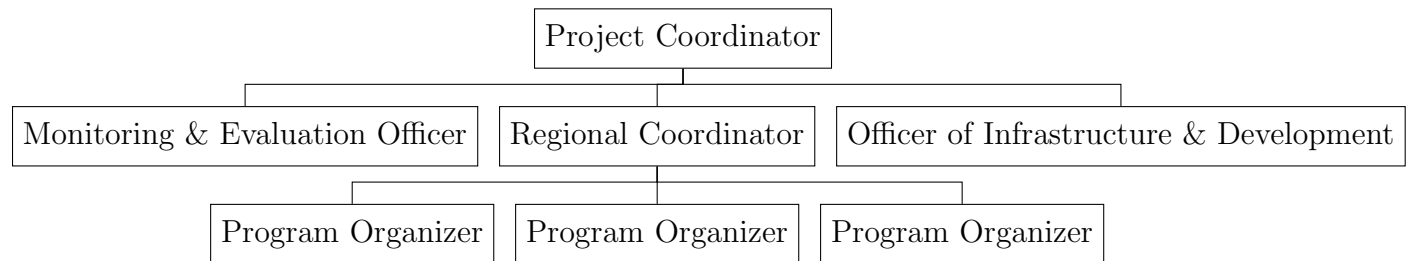
Talha Tasnim – Officer Project Monitoring & Evaluation, Urban Development Program
Experience: Over 5 years of experience in project management and urban planning.

Role:

- Conducting monitoring of program processes, results and immediate outcomes in the target towns and cities
- Identifying monitoring issues, setting up indicators, developing questionnaires and other tools for data collection
- Conducting surveys, stakeholder consultations, in-depth interviews, key informant interviews, FGDs, and other tools for collecting qualitative and quantitative data

- Disseminating monitoring & MIS findings with respective staff and other relevant stakeholders
- Implementing and establishing real-time monitoring systems using ICT and regularly data downloading, rechecking, and putting feedback from the website
- Proving community organizers & program organizers assets for smooth data collection by using ICT
- Ensuring quality of implementing activities and finding gaps between target versus achievement
- Providing different training for monitoring data collection by mobile platform
- Preparing monthly, quarterly, and annual reports (with observations & recommendations), submitting to Head Office and qualitative, and quantitative reports for regional office
- Identifying and documenting case stories on significant success or failure as well as on programmatic learning and good practices

3.3 Project team structure



3.3.1 Description of Roles

Program Organizer (PO)

Responsibilities:

- Purchase and distribute livelihood resources among community members.
- Build and maintain relationships with community members.
- Collaborate with local authorities, such as counselors.

Regional Coordinator (RC)

Responsibilities:

- Manage and guide Program Organizers.
- Provide plans and ensure proper communication for efficient project execution.
- Accountable for resolving issues in the project.
- Experienced in handling both upper and lower layers of the organization.

Project Coordinator (PC)

Responsibilities:

- Develop top-to-bottom guidelines for the project.
- Ensure the guidelines are executed by the Regional Coordinator and Program Organizers.

Monitoring & Evaluation Officer (MEO)

Responsibilities:

- Evaluate the project guidelines set by the Project Coordinator. Ensure the project follows standard criteria.
- Maintain communication with donors and provide the necessary information.

Officer of Infrastructure & Development (OID)

Responsibilities:

- Design proper infrastructure for the project.
- Ensure the designed infrastructure is followed during project implementation.

3.4 Key Responsibilities & Activities

Based on the interviews conducted several core responsibilities and activities related to systems analysis and design were identified. These responsibilities, while not attributed to a single role titled "system analyst," are distributed among various individuals within the organization. Below is a summary of these key responsibilities and activities:

3.4.1 Requirement Gathering and Analysis:

Description:

Collecting and analyzing the requirements for various urban development projects is a critical activity. This involves engaging with stakeholders, including community members, project managers, and field coordinators, to understand their needs and expectations.

Key Activities:

- Conducting interviews and surveys with stakeholders to gather requirements.
- Documenting and validating requirements to ensure they are clear and complete.
- Prioritizing requirements based on project objectives and resource availability.

3.4.2 Process Modeling and Workflow Design:

Description:

Designing and modeling workflows and processes to ensure efficient project execution and resource management.

Key Activities:

- Identifying bottlenecks and areas for improvement within existing processes.
- Identifying bottlenecks and areas for improvement within existing processes.

3.4.3 System Design and Implementation:

Description:

Designing and implementing systems that support the operational needs of the projects.

Key Activities:

- Creating requirement specifications and design documents.
- Selecting appropriate technologies and tools to meet the project requirements.

3.4.4 Data Management and Analysis:

Description:

Managing and analyzing data collected from various projects to provide actionable insights and support decision-making.

Key Activities:

- Establishing data collection protocols and standards.
- Analyzing data to identify trends, patterns, and insights.

3.4.5 Training and Support:**Description:**

Providing training and ongoing support to users to ensure they can effectively use the systems implemented.

Key Activities:

- Developing training materials and user guides.
- Conducting training sessions for staff and community members.
- Offering technical support and troubleshooting assistance as needed.

The collaborative efforts of project managers, IT coordinators, field coordinators ensure that systems are effectively designed, implemented, and maintained to fulfill the project requirement.

3.5 Skills & Qualifications

The interview conducted with the employee highlighted several essential skills and qualifications necessary for performing tasks related to the project. These skills are distributed across various roles within the organization, contributing to the overall effectiveness of the project.

Below is a summary of the key skills and qualifications identified:

3.5.1 Interpersonal Skills:**Communication:**

- Excellent verbal and written communication skills to interact with stakeholders at all levels.
- Ability to convey complex technical information in a clear and understandable manner.

Collaboration:

- Strong teamwork skills to work effectively with cross-functional teams.
- Ability to facilitate discussions and build consensus among diverse groups.

3.5.2 Technical Proficiency:

Software and Tools:

- Proficiency in using various software and tools relevant to the project for collecting information and analysis.

Project Management Skills:

Planning and Organization:

- Strong organizational skills to manage multiple projects and tasks simultaneously.
- Ability to develop detailed project plans, including timelines, milestones, and resource allocation.

3.5.3 Analytical Skills:

Requirement Analysis:

- Strong analytical skills to gather and interpret project requirements accurately.
- Ability to prioritize and translate requirements into functional specifications.

3.6 Challenges & Opportunities

UDP revealed several challenges and opportunities during the completion of a project. Understanding these challenges and leveraging the opportunities can significantly enhance the effectiveness of the organization

3.6.1 Data Management Issues:

Inconsistent Data Collection:

- Variability in data collection methods across different projects leads to inconsistencies, making it challenging to analyze and integrate data effectively.

Impact:

- Inconsistent and insecure data management can lead to inaccurate analyses and decision-making, affecting project outcomes.

3.6.2 Technological Challenges:

Integration Difficulties:

- Integrating new data with existing ones is complex and time-consuming, often requiring extensive evaluation and verification.

Impact:

- Technological challenges can delay project timelines and increase costs, limiting the organization's ability to scale operations.

3.6.3 Communication Barriers:**Interdepartmental Coordination::**

- Ensuring effective communication and coordination among various departments and field staff is often challenging.

Impact:

- Poor communication can lead to misunderstandings, misaligned goals, and reduced project efficiency.

3.6.4 Opportunities:**Capacity Building:**

- Training and Development Programs:
 - Investing in training programs to enhance the skills of existing staff in areas such as data analysis, project management, and new technologies.
- Professional Certifications:
 - Encouraging staff to obtain relevant certifications can improve their expertise and contribute to better project outcomes.

Strengthening Communication and Collaboration:

- Integrated Communication Platforms:
 - Using integrated communication platforms to facilitate real-time collaboration among team members and departments.
- Benefit:
 - Enhanced communication can lead to better coordination, clearer understanding of goals, and more efficient project execution.

3.7 Conclusion

The insights gathered from the interviews with key stakeholders at BRAC UDP highlight the critical roles and responsibilities related to systems analysis and design within the organization. Despite the absence of a formal title of "system analyst," various individuals contribute significantly to these activities, ensuring the successful execution of urban development projects.

The primary responsibilities identified include requirement gathering and analysis, project planning and implementation, data management and training and support. These activities are essential for creating effective systems that meet the organization's needs and support its mission.

Key skills and qualifications necessary for these roles encompass a range of technical, interpersonal, and project management competencies. These skills enable individuals to perform their tasks effectively, ensuring the smooth operation and success of BRAC UDP's projects.

In conclusion, understanding the distributed responsibilities and activities related to systems analysis and design within BRAC UDP provides valuable insights into how the organization can improve its processes and achieve its objectives more effectively. Addressing the identified challenges and leveraging the opportunities will enable BRAC UDP to continue making a positive impact on urban communities through innovative and efficient urban development projects.

Chapter 4

Systems Planning and the Initial Investigation

4.1 Introduction

Systems Planning and Initial Investigation are foundational steps in urban development, essential for the creation of effective, sustainable, and inclusive urban environments. These processes involve a thorough examination of existing urban conditions, identifying challenges and opportunities, and engaging with stakeholders to gather relevant data. This information is crucial for designing comprehensive urban development plans that address the needs of diverse communities, enhance infrastructure, and promote economic growth. Effective systems planning ensures that resources are allocated efficiently, and urban interventions are aligned with long-term development goals.

In the context of BRAC's urban development initiatives in Bangladesh, these steps are vital for addressing the complex challenges faced by rapidly growing cities. BRAC focuses on improving access to basic services, upgrading informal settlements, and fostering community participation to build resilient and equitable urban spaces. By conducting initial investigations and planning systematically, BRAC aims to transform urban areas into inclusive, livable, and sustainable environments, ultimately improving the quality of life for urban residents, particularly those in marginalized communities.

4.2 Initial Investigation

Before launching new urban development projects, BRAC conducts a comprehensive initial investigation process to ensure the initiatives are tailored to the needs of the communities they aim to serve. This process involves several key steps:

4.2.1 Needs Assessment

BRAC undertakes thorough needs assessments in the targeted urban areas. This involves engaging with community members to understand their specific challenges and requirements.

The assessments cover various aspects such as housing, access to basic services (healthcare, education, water, and sanitation), and economic opportunities.

4.2.2 Community Mobilization

BRAC works closely with local residents, particularly focusing on women and youth, to form groups that can articulate their needs and priorities. This grassroots approach ensures that the solutions are community-driven and sustainable.

4.2.3 Stakeholder Engagement

BRAC collaborates with a wide range of stakeholders, including government bodies, non-governmental organizations, private sector partners, and international donors. This collaboration is essential for integrating services and leveraging resources effectively.

4.2.4 Pilot Projects

Before scaling up, BRAC often implements pilot projects to test innovative solutions in small, controlled environments. These pilots help identify effective practices and allow for adjustments based on real-world feedback and outcomes.

4.2.5 Policy Advocacy

BRAC engages in advocacy to influence urban policies that promote inclusive development. They work with policymakers to ensure that urban plans and housing policies address the needs of low-income communities and promote equitable access to services.

4.2.6 Research and Data Collection

Continuous research and data collection are integral to BRAC's approach. By keeping data at the core of their decisions, they ensure that their interventions are evidence-based and aligned with the latest urban development trends and needs.

4.3 Resource Allocation

BRAC allocates its resources in a strategic and multifaceted manner to ensure the effective implementation of its urban development projects. The allocation of resources is guided by several key principles and processes:

4.3.1 Community-Centered Approach

Engaging Local Communities

BRAC prioritizes engaging local communities in the planning and implementation stages of its projects. This ensures that resources are directed towards initiatives that address the

specific needs and priorities of the communities.

Empowering Local Leaders

By forming groups of residents, especially women and youth, BRAC facilitates community-led identification of problems and solutions. This approach helps in the efficient allocation of resources towards the most pressing issues identified by the community members themselves.

4.3.2 Collaborative Partnerships

Public-Private Partnerships

BRAC collaborates with government bodies, private sector entities, and other NGOs to pool resources and expertise. This collaboration helps in leveraging additional funding, technical support, and implementation capacity.

International Donors and Development Partners

By engaging with international donors and development organizations, BRAC secures funding and support for large-scale projects. This allows for a more significant impact and the ability to scale successful pilot projects.

4.3.3 Integrated Services

Multi-Sectoral Integration

BRAC integrates services across sectors such as health, education, water, and sanitation. By doing so, they ensure that resources are used efficiently and that projects address multiple needs simultaneously, providing comprehensive support to urban communities.

4.3.4 Sustainability and Scalability

Long-Term Planning

Resources are allocated with a focus on long-term sustainability and scalability. BRAC ensures that projects not only address immediate needs but also contribute to long-term urban resilience and development.

Environmental Considerations

BRAC incorporates environmentally friendly practices in their projects, such as promoting green infrastructure and sustainable housing solutions. This approach helps in creating more resilient urban environments and ensures that resources contribute to sustainable development.

4.4 Prototyping

BRAC uses prototyping in their urban development projects as a key strategy to test and refine innovative solutions before scaling them up. This approach allows them to pilot new ideas on a small scale, gather feedback, and make necessary adjustments to ensure effectiveness and sustainability. Here's how BRAC incorporates prototyping into their projects:

4.4.1 Pilot Projects

BRAC frequently implements pilot projects to test new concepts and approaches in real-world settings. For instance, in response to the housing crisis following a fire in Korail, BRAC redesigned and redeveloped over 500 homes as a pilot initiative. This effort involved collaboration with government entities and other stakeholders to explore community-led housing models and low-cost rental solutions.

4.4.2 Innovative Interventions

The Urban Development Programme (UDP) focuses on identifying good practices and harnessing grassroots innovation. BRAC supports community-led initiatives where local residents, particularly women and youth, take the lead in identifying problems and developing solutions. These grassroots innovations are often piloted to assess their feasibility and impact.

4.4.3 Urban Innovation Challenge

BRAC organizes the Urban Innovation Challenge, which promotes and supports innovative solutions for urban sustainability. This initiative invites innovators to propose and prototype new ideas aimed at addressing urban challenges. Successful prototypes from the challenge are then considered for further development and scaling.

4.4.4 Customization and Flexibility

Recognizing that each urban area has unique characteristics and needs, BRAC customizes its prototypes to fit specific contexts. This flexible approach ensures that solutions are tailored to the local environment and can be adapted based on feedback from the community and other stakeholders.

4.5 Conclusion

BRAC's commitment to systems planning and the initial investigation has been instrumental in shaping its Urban Development Program into a comprehensive and effective initiative. By embracing a holistic approach and leveraging community participation, BRAC continues to make significant strides in creating inclusive and resilient urban environments, ultimately contributing to the overall goal of sustainable urban development.

Chapter 5

Analyzing BRAC's Policies, Objectives, Goals, Structure, System, Leadership, History, and an Interview

5.1 Introduction

BRAC (Bangladesh Rural Advancement Committee) is one of the largest non-governmental development organizations in the world. Established in 1972, BRAC aims to alleviate poverty and empower the poor through various programs and initiatives. This report explores BRAC's policies, objectives, goals, structure, system, leadership, and its historical development. Additionally, it includes an interview with Talha Tasnim, an officer in BRAC's Urban Development Program.

5.2 Methodology

Information was collected from BRAC's official documents, reports, credible online sources, and an interview with Talha Tasnim.

5.3 Results

5.3.1 BRAC's Policies

BRAC implements a wide range of policies aimed at social and economic development, environmental sustainability, and gender equality. These policies include:

- **Social Development Policies:** Focused on education, health, and legal aid.
- **Economic Development Policies:** Targeting microfinance, agriculture, and enterprise development.

- **Environmental Policies:** Addressing climate change adaptation and promoting renewable energy.
- **Gender Equality Policies:** Ensuring women's empowerment and gender parity in all initiatives.

5.3.2 BRAC's Objectives

BRAC's primary objectives are to:

- Alleviate poverty and promote sustainable development.
- Empower marginalized communities, especially women.
- Improve health, education, and economic opportunities for the poor.
- Promote social justice and gender equality.

5.3.3 BRAC's Goals

BRAC aims to:

- Reach millions of people with its poverty alleviation programs.
- Scale up its initiatives globally.
- Foster inclusive development and resilience among vulnerable populations.
- Innovate and implement sustainable development models.

5.3.4 Organizational Structure

BRAC follows a hierarchical organizational structure with a clear chain of command. It consists of a governing body, an executive board, and various program-specific divisions and departments.

5.3.5 Type of System

BRAC operates as a non-governmental organization (NGO) that delivers a wide array of development programs. These programs focus on health, education, economic development, and social justice to enhance the lives of the poor.

5.3.6 Leadership and Key Personnel

BRAC's system is run by a diverse leadership team comprising professionals with expertise in various fields. Important figures include the founder, Sir Fazle Hasan Abed, and the current executive team, which oversees different operational areas.

5.4 Data Flow Diagram of BRAC

The data flow diagram (DFD) of BRAC illustrates the flow of information within the organization's systems and processes. At its core, BRAC's DFD represents the movement of data from its source to its destination, highlighting the various activities and interactions involved in managing information across different functional areas. The figure represents the DFD of BRAC's working.

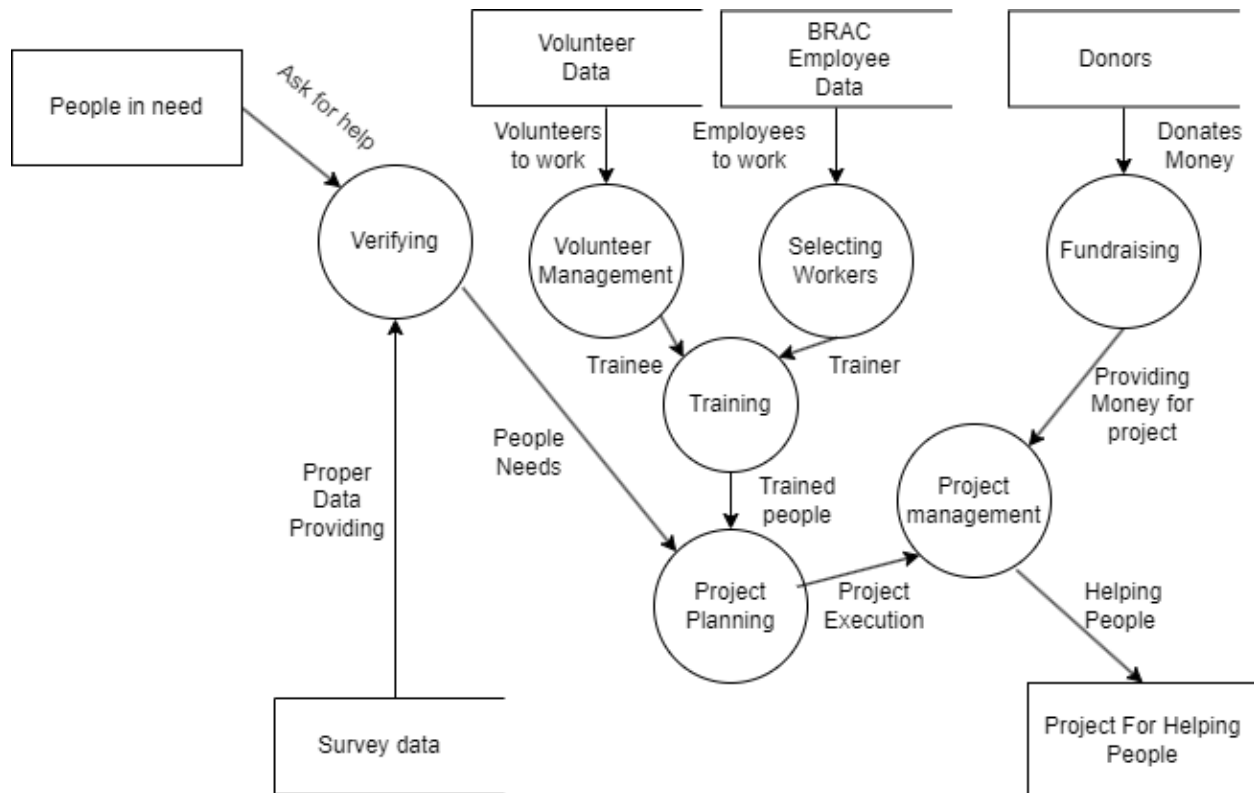


Figure 5.1: Data Flow Diagram of BRAC.

The DFD typically consists of the following components:

- **External Entities:** These are entities outside the organization that interact with BRAC's systems. They could include beneficiaries, donors, government agencies, partner organizations, etc.
- **Processes:** Processes represent the activities or tasks performed within BRAC's systems. These could include fundraising, project management, training, project planning, etc.
- **Data Stores:** Data stores are repositories where data is stored within BRAC's systems. These could include databases, files, documents, etc.
- **Data Flows:** Data flows represent the movement of data between external entities, processes, and data stores within the DFD. They illustrate how data is exchanged and transformed as it moves through the system.

The DFD of BRAC provides a visual representation of how information flows within the organization, helping to identify potential bottlenecks, inefficiencies, and opportunities for optimization. By understanding the data flow within BRAC's systems, the organization can streamline processes, enhance communication, and improve decision-making to better serve its stakeholders and achieve its mission.

You can further elaborate on specific processes, data stores, and data flows within BRAC's DFD based on the available information and requirements.

5.5 Interview with Talha Tasnim

In which department do you work?

I work in the Urban Development Department at BRAC.

What is the main function of your department?

Our department has three main functions:

1. **Basic services:** Ensuring safe, affordable, and quality services for the urban poor, including health, education, Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH), legal aid, crisis management, and financial inclusion.
2. **Economic empowerment:** Facilitating livelihoods, skills, and entrepreneurship opportunities, urban agriculture, and market linkages.
3. **Low-cost housing and slum upgrading:** Ensuring adequate, safe, and affordable housing and overall slum upgrading, including drainage, footpaths, access to roads, lighting, solar energy, waste management, and tree plantation.
4. **Climate change, disaster risk response, and environment:** Promoting pro-poor urban development, and integrating climate change, disaster response, and environment into city planning.
5. **Urban planning and governance through policy advocacy:** Strengthening urban planning and governance for inclusive and resilient urban development and improving public service delivery mechanisms.
6. **Emergency support:** Supporting people living in low-income communities in cities during crises.

What is your role in this company?

I am currently an Officer in the Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) division at BRAC, specifically working within the Urban Development Program (UDP) in Mymensingh, Bangladesh.

What does your department do to implement its plans?

We implement our plans through:

1. **Service integration:** Leveraging a strong referral system to access affordable and quality services through partnerships and collaboration with the government, non-governmental organizations, and the private sector.
2. **Community-NGO-private partnerships:** Joint investment, planning, and decision-making for financial, social, and environmental sustainability.
3. **Piloting and scaling self-sustaining models:** Innovative models that use cost sharing and cost recovery approaches to ensure sustainability.

Is BRAC fully digitalized?

BRAC actively implements digital solutions but isn't fully digitalized, considering remote areas and digital literacy.

In which portion of BRAC is digitalized?

BRAC's microfinance program and bank, BRAC Bank, are actively implementing digital solutions.

How many branches does it have?

We are currently providing our services through 2000+ branches.

Does BRAC have its own server?

Yes, we have our own server.

What is the work environment and culture like at the company?

The work environment is comfortable, women-friendly, and liberal.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I enjoyed learning more about BRAC and look forward to hearing from you soon.

You're most welcome.

5.6 Conclusion

BRAC's comprehensive approach to development through a variety of policies and programs has made significant impacts globally. With a strong leadership team, effective organizational structure, and a commitment to innovation, BRAC continues to pioneer solutions for poverty alleviation and sustainable development. The interview with Talha Tasnim provides insight into the practical implementation and impact of BRAC's initiatives, particularly in urban development.